



To escape the Earth's gravity, a rocket has to reach just over 11 km (7 miles) per second. This is called the escape velocity.

Biggest and best

The *Saturn V* were the largest, and most powerful, rockets ever built. They were used 13 times, between 1967 and 1973, including for the first Moon landing.



Types of rocket

There are many different kinds of rocket.



Soyuz rockets are used by astronauts to reach the International Space Station.



Saturn V were the largest rockets ever built. They were used to launch all the Moon landings.



Firework rockets are used for celebrations.



Military rockets have been used for hundreds of years.



Experimental rockets provide information about fast and high flight.



Some satellites have small rocket engines to position them once they are in orbit.

Regular launches

Today, rockets such as *Ariane 5* are used to launch satellites into space. A satellite is a rocket's payload, or cargo, whose size determines whether it is sent up by a small or large rocket.

This is the *Ariane 5* launch vehicle. The main tank contains 25 tonnes (27.5 tons) of liquid hydrogen. The tubes on each side are solid fuel boosters that supply extra power for lift-off.